



Society for Academic Freedom and Scholarship

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6 October 2016

Michael J. Mahon, PhD
President, University of Lethbridge
4401 University Drive
Lethbridge, AB T1K 3M4

Dear Dr Mahon,

I am writing as president of the Society for Academic Freedom and Scholarship (SAFS), a national organization of university faculty members and others dedicated to the defense of academic freedom and reasoned and respectful debate. (For further information, please see our website at www.safs.ca.)

According to a report today by the CBC (<http://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/calgary/tony-hall-suspended-lethbridge-1.3793294>), Professor Anthony Hall has been suspended from teaching and prohibited from entering your university's campus. The report states that the University of Lethbridge is investigating Dr Hall for possible violations of the Human Rights Act.

Suspending a professor is, as you know, an extreme form of discipline. It is difficult to see what in this case would warrant it. Dr Hall is not alleged to

be an incompetent or fraudulent researcher, nor an incompetent or abusive teacher. So far as the information that has been made public goes, he has been suspended for having and expressing views with which administrators disagree. Now even if administrators find his expressed views repugnant,

academic freedom protects his rights to have them and to express them publicly.

In light of these considerations, SAFS would like to ask you how Dr Hall's suspension is not a violation of his academic freedom and how his suspension will not tend to create a chilly climate for expression on campus.

SAFS looks forward to hearing from you. We will post this letter on our website. With your permission, we will be pleased to post your reply together with it.

Yours sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Mark Mercer', with a stylized, flowing script.

Mark Mercer, PhD
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Cc: Kurt E. Schlachter, Chair, Board of Governors